CROSS-BORDER NOTES

A bank compliance team in Amman cut me off mid-pitch. They didn't want the impact story. They wanted to know if my climate data gets them closer to their green lending quota.

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Sustainability teams write the narrative. They do not sign the purchase order.

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Compliance teams own the quota. Missing it triggers a regulatory penalty, not a bad headline.

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Local banks buy climate data because the cost of non-compliance is priced and dated. Goodwill is not.

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Even Korean investor deals are pushed by a regulatory deadline on the buyer's desk, not pulled by an impact thesis.

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Reading ESG pitch decks to size demand? Read the mandate instead. Find out who gets penalized, and by when.

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